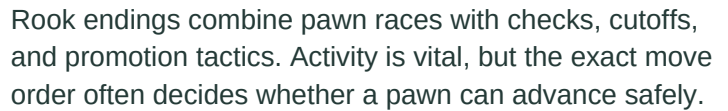


Rook-ending tactics

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on c6. Check for tactical protection.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

63...Kb5 The king moves from c4 to b5. Recorded reply: **64.Rc8**.

64...Rxa2 The rook captures the pawn on a2.

At the end, nominal material is White 6 / Black 6 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -1 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.